EXECUTIVE DEPARTMENT
STATE OF CALIFORNIA

EXECUTIVE ORDER N-30-25

WHEREAS California is the 4th largest economy in the world and the home of Silicon Valley, which is synonymous with bold innovations that have improved daily life and business models worldwide; and

WHEREAS thousands of California startups, technology companies, and cloud-service providers have ushered in a new age of digital services that has made business faster, more dynamic, and better able to deliver seamless customer experiences; and

WHEREAS this revolution in digital services has created higher customer expectations for Californians that federal, state and local government meet their needs as quickly and intuitively as private sector businesses do; and

WHEREAS California is a leader in Generative AI (GenAI) testing and solution development, with 32 out of 50 of the top AI companies headquartered in California, all benefiting from the deep well of talent and our globally recognized innovation ecosystem; and

WHEREAS California state government is advancing public sector use of advanced analytics and data science through the work of departments such as the California Department of Technology (CDT), the Center for Data Insights and Information (CDII), and the Office of Data Innovation (ODI); and

WHEREAS I have prioritized efforts to innovate and improve efficiency in the delivery of governmental services by agencies and departments within my Administration, including:

- During my first week in office, I issued Executive Order N-4-19, which established a new procurement process known as the Request for Innovative Ideas (RFI2) to solicit proposals from the private sector to solve a problem identified by a state agency, with the first RFI2 focused on addressing the State's wildfire crisis and resulting in the delivery of wildfire monitoring cameras across the state that were operational for the 2020 wildfire season;
- In 2019, newly appointed leadership at the Department of Motor Vehicles (DMV) overhauled department practices via a DMV Strike Team to manage a surge in customer wait times related to the implementation of the Federal REAL ID Act, and since that time, DMV has expanded online services, created a virtual field office, added a credit card payment option, and developed a mobile driver's license option, while reducing and maintaining wait times at consistently low levels;
- In partnership with the Legislature, I established ODI in 2019 as an office of technology experts dedicated to supporting other state agencies and departments to utilize data, technology, and principles of human centered design that are common in the private sector to improve the delivery of services to Californians; and
- The California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection (CalFIRE) has developed and deployed cutting-edge technology to model wildfire risks and support wildland firefighting, including:
    - developing sophisticated data modeling to predict geographic areas where risk of fire starts is greatest and incorporating this information into the prepositioning approval process;

    - partnering with the U.S. Department of Defense to use satellites for wildfire detection;
    - investing in LiDAR technology to create detailed 3D maps of high-risk areas, which helps firefighters better understand and navigate complex terrains;
    - leveraging AI-powered tools to identify fires faster and developing the Fire Integrated Real-Time Intelligence System (FIRIS) to provide real-time mapping and modeling of wildfires;
    - doubling deployment of drones for critical tasks like aerial ignition during prescribed burns, wildfire containment, and real-time assessments; and
    - expanding capabilities for incident reporting at fire.ca.gov, updating the incident map with near real time information about firefighting aircraft activity, 3-D maps with evacuation orders, local shelter information, road closures, and more;
- In 2023, I issued Executive Order N-12-23, which directed the Government Operations Agency, the California Department of General Services, and the CDT to update the state's project approval, procurement, and contracting processes for GenAI; CDT recently updated its statewide policies, including safeguards required by my Executive Order to ensure the responsible use of GenAI; and CDT also implemented a Project Delivery Lifecycle (PDL) to update the state's project approval process for GenAI projects to meet the requirements of my Executive Order, offering opportunities to expand that new procurement process to non-GenAI projects; and
- The California Department of Tax and Fee Administration (CDTFA) has streamlined processes and harnessed technology to drastically improve efficiency, improving revenue collection on existing taxes while using fewer resources, cutting the department's cost to administer a dollar of revenue by more than 24 percent since 2019; and

WHEREAS the efforts to date are important, but state government can and should do more to meet Californians' high expectations; and

WHEREAS this transformation will require re-engineering state government with a focus on human-centered design and user experience; data collection to establish or confirm baselines and transparently track progress; and the subject matter expertise of program leaders and frontline staff who serve Californians daily; and

WHEREAS California led the nation in safely testing and implementing GenAI in the public sector, harnessing the power of transformative new technologies to drive efficiency and effectiveness at scale; and

WHEREAS California has recently launched a first-in-the-nation deliberative democracy program, Engaged California, to hear directly from Californians and to inform policymakers about the issues that affect them the most; and

WHEREAS California, endeavors to attract, retain, and develop employees who will support a modern and responsive state government and provide an excellent customer experience to all Californians, and our state workforce has deep expertise in the programs they run that can inform improvements to how the State delivers services to Californians.

NOW, THEREFORE, I, GAVIN NEWSOM, Governor of the State of California, in accordance with the authority vested in me by the State Constitution and statutes of the State of California, do hereby issue the following Order to become effective immediately: